



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Law enforcement

BEFORE

1870s The American detective agency Pinkerton begins to share information with British and French police forces.

1910 Murderer Dr. Hawley Crippen flees Britain on a ship but is arrested in Canada after an incriminating telegram is forwarded to British authorities by the ship's captain.

1914 The first International Criminal Police Congress is held in Monaco.

1923 The International Criminal Police Commission (ICPC) is set up in Vienna.

AFTER

1946 INTERPOL introduces its color notices, including red for murder suspects and yellow for missing persons.

2000 Automated fingerprint matching is introduced.

A SAFER WORLD

INTERPOL (1945)

Based in Lyon, France, INTERPOL is an international organization with a brief to coordinate efforts by different nations' police forces to fight crime that crosses national borders. Its work has become especially significant in tackling the drug trade, sex trafficking, and terrorism. It also has important day-to-day tasks such as notifying relatives of deaths abroad.

Foreign getaways

The idea of international law-enforcement cooperation began in the mid-19th century. In the 1850s, Prussian detectives, with British support, kept tabs on German philosopher and socialist revolutionary Karl Marx in London. In the 1870s, the Pinkerton detective agency in the United States shared information with Britain's Scotland Yard and France's Sûreté—all three agencies were eager to catch Adam Worth,

an American bank robber who had moved to Europe and established a crime network in London and Paris.

The first concerted effort to formally establish a degree of police cooperation across borders came in 1914, when delegates from 24 countries met in Monaco. They wanted to pool identification techniques and work out how to catch fugitives. Although the Monaco Congress may have been limited in its achievements because it was arranged between legal experts and politicians, not

The 1898 assassination of Empress Elisabeth of Austria was one of several crimes that underscored the need for international police cooperation. She was stabbed by Italian anarchist Luigi Lucheni while in Geneva, Switzerland.

